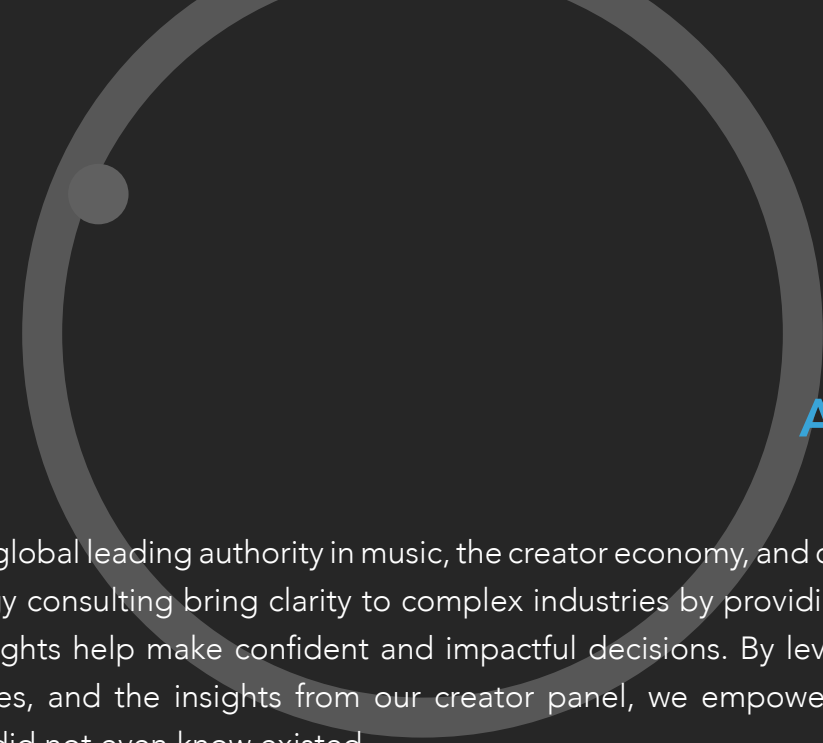


MIDIA.

All eyes, no ears | Why virality is not building fandom

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About MIDiA Research

MIDiA Research is the global leading authority in music, the creator economy, and cross-entertainment. Our subscriptions, data tools, and strategy consulting bring clarity to complex industries by providing support and expertise. Our trusted data and powerful insights help make confident and impactful decisions. By leveraging multi-country consumer data, forecasts, market shares, and the insights from our creator panel, we empower clients to think differently, revealing unique solutions they did not even know existed.

With our deep understanding of both the business and culture of entertainment, we work with entertainment companies to navigate tough industry challenges. Driven by a passion for discovering new knowledge, insights, and solutions, our team nurtures creativity and innovation to consistently deliver dependable results.

For more details visit our website:

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Or email us at info@midiaresearch.com

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KEY INSIGHTS

- **Discovery is highly fragmented, but YouTube leads a large pack:** No single source of discovery dominates, as seven different sources all have at least 10% of consumers discovering music, but YouTube reaches the most at 52%
- **The funnel is not working on social media:** Almost half of consumers did not stream music because they heard it on social media in the last month
- **Social media is not driving streams for the majority:** 48% of YouTube weekly active users (WAUs) say they spend more time streaming music because of YouTube, compared to 34% of TikTok WAUs and 23% of Instagram WAUs on their respective platforms
- **Social media is not where discovery begins:** 87% of consumers hear music on social media, but most of them (58%) say they have often already heard it in other places first
- **The funnel towards streaming is down for younger consumers:** After hearing music on social media, 16-24-year-olds are less likely than 25-34-year-olds to take almost every step through the funnel, particularly streaming the songs they hear and listening to more music from the artists they discover
- **TikTok users would rather follow than listen to more:** Consumers who mainly discover music on TikTok are significantly more likely to follow that artist on TikTok (35%) than they are to listen to more of that artist's music (23%)
- **TikTok followers convert into listeners less than other social platforms:** Of the 20% of consumers who followed artists on TikTok after discovering them, only 26% listened to more of that artist's music. Of the 15% of consumers who followed artists and discovered them on other social platforms, 45% listened to more of that artist's music
- **Discovery is a cycle, not a funnel:** Consumers will come back to indulge in what they are first exposed to. If that is a clip or a hook of a song, they will stay in places where they can experience that same hook. If discovery starts with the artist, they will find ways to dive deeper
- **Entertainment has become a zero-sum game:** There is little room to carve out new spaces for attention, meaning social media's growth

INTRODUCTION

Over the last five years, labels and artists have invested in social media, betting that a steady stream of artist content and influencer campaigns will engineer virality. The theory is simple: virality leads to streams, streams lead to fandom, and fandom leads to long-term, sustainable artist careers. With fandom pivotal for sustainable growth, the music industry does not simply want this vision to work – it needs it to. However, cracks are showing in social's social contract.

Artists such as Lola Young ('Messy'), Chrystal ('The Days'), and Kenya Grace ('Strangers') have all struck viral gold. Yet, despite generating hundreds of millions of streams, these tracks have not translated to uplift across their broader catalogues. People love these songs – why are they not exploring more from the artists? Why do viral hits not always deliver armies of fans? This is more than a music business dilemma. It is a fundamental question about the exchange rate between effort on social platforms and music fandom that results, and whether the benefits of virality flow more to platforms than to artists.

Today's 16-24-year-olds are less likely than 25-34-year-olds to have discovered an artist they love in the last year.

This complex question requires a sophisticated approach to answer it. We have employed a global study of 10,000 consumers and their discovery habits across platforms – illuminating not only how, why, and where discovery moments happen, but also what happens next.

Discovery is not the goal, it is a means to an end. Although discovery does not pay the bills, it is what it leads to that does.

It is clear that music discovery is at a generational crossroads. Music discovery is traditionally associated with youth, but today's 16-24-year-olds are less likely than 25-34-year-olds to have discovered an artist they love in the last year – and less likely to listen to more music from that artist when they do. TikTok is gaining ground among the youngest users, and when they do engage with music on the platform, they often stay within the app's walls.

When songs hit peak virality, as with Lola Young and 'Messy', it is a clear win for the song. In an industry betting on fandom, however, music discovery needs victories for the artists. In this study, we present the pitfalls and possibilities of a music discovery ecosystem that is ripe – if not desperate – for change.

STATE OF DISCOVERY

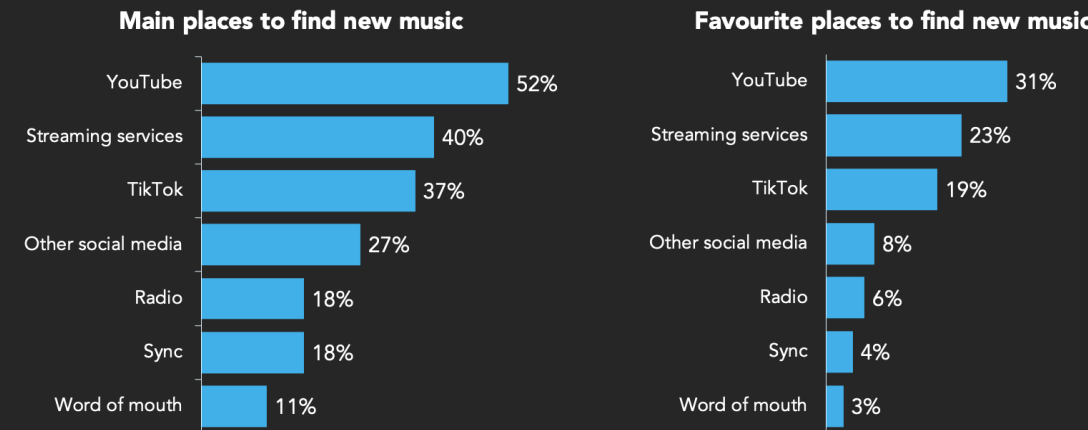
Discovery is fragmented for everyone

YouTube has the biggest reach among music discovery methods, with 52% of consumers naming it one of their main places for discovering new music, followed by streaming (40%) and TikTok (37%). Nonetheless, discovery goes further than the top three sources, with a total of seven different methods commanding more than 10% penetration each, followed by a long tail of other methods, each registering single-digit penetration rates.

There are clear demographic divides at the extremes, with younger audiences skewing towards TikTok and older audiences towards radio.

Music discovery is fragmented, with YouTube, streaming services, and TikTok leading the way

Main places and favourite places consumers find new music



Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25) US, UK, Australia, Canada, Germany, France, Mexico, Brazil, Japan, Indonesia, n =10,016. Q11/12. Thinking about the music you listen to, which of these are the main/favourite places you find new music? (Select all that apply)



However, looking at the bigger picture, only 12% of consumers are 16-24-year-olds who discover music on TikTok. The music industry’s focus on breaking music to this group essentially neglects 88% of the population.

There is no single source of discovery that dominates, reflecting the complex and intertwined lives that consumers lead.

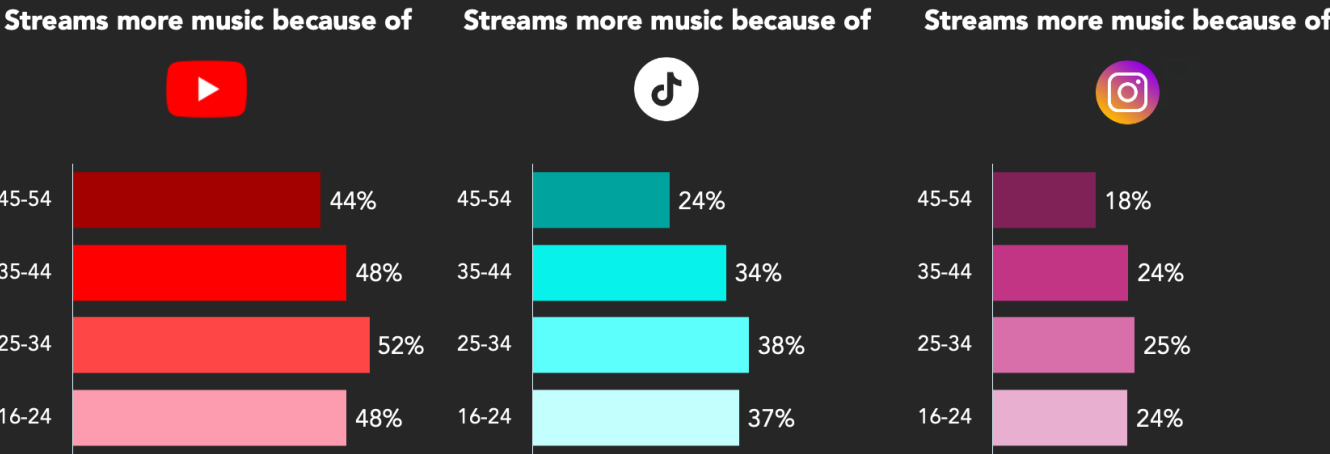
Social does not drive more music streaming for most consumers

While social media and viral music have helped drive song streams, this is attributed to a subset of consumers, rather than the majority of them. 48% of YouTube weekly active users (WAUs) say they spend more time streaming music because of YouTube, compared to 34% of TikTok WAUs and 23% of Instagram WAUs who say the same about their respective platforms.

YouTube – a music video destination with YouTube Music in its ecosystem – is naturally the strongest driver of streams.

TikTok and Instagram, however, have far less incentive to get their users to stream more music. Doing so means users leave the platform behind to be monetised elsewhere. This underlines that social media is just one part of a wide and diverse discovery ecosystem. More often than not, it is this mix of other sources that is a bigger driver of discovery than social media alone.

Consumers who say they stream more music because of the platform they use



Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25) US, UK, Australia, Canada, Germany, France, Mexico, Brazil, Japan, Indonesia, n =10,016. Q9. How has YouTube / TikTok / Instagram impacted the time you spend streaming music?



Social media is just one part of a wide and diverse discovery ecosystem.

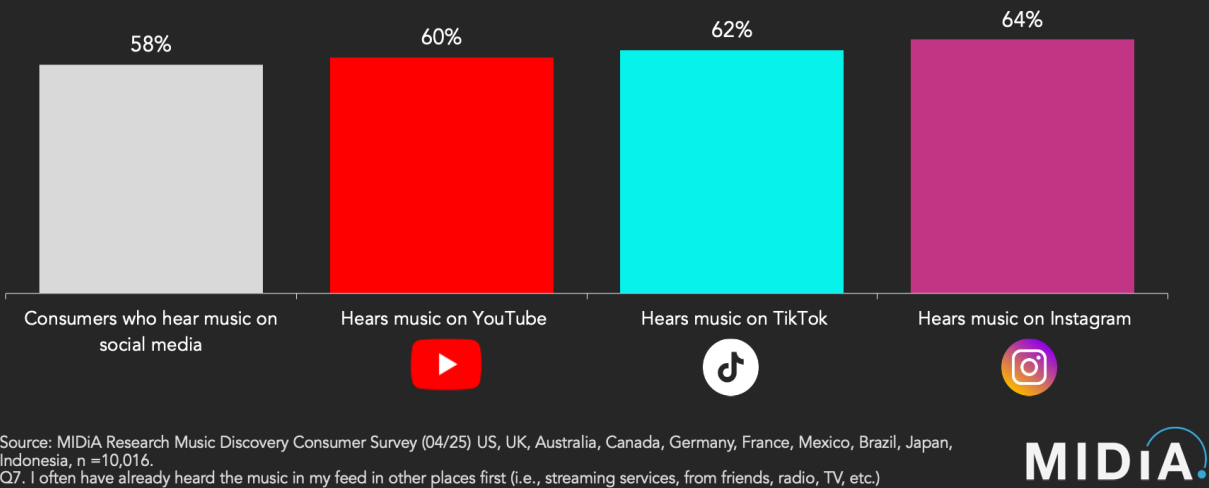
Most music is first heard outside of social media

Most consumers who hear music in their social media feeds say they have often already heard it in other places first. This is the case for those who hear music on YouTube, TikTok, and Instagram, the three most popular platforms by WAUs. This is also consistent across all age groups, with even younger consumers leaning more towards social media.

87% of consumers hear music on social media, but the fact that so many are hearing that music for the first time elsewhere underlines the importance of other discovery sources in breaking new music. Music on social media is as much a reflection of what is happening in the wider music consumption ecosystem as it is a driver of it.

Social media is not the first place that most people hear music

Consumers who have already heard the music in their feed in other places first



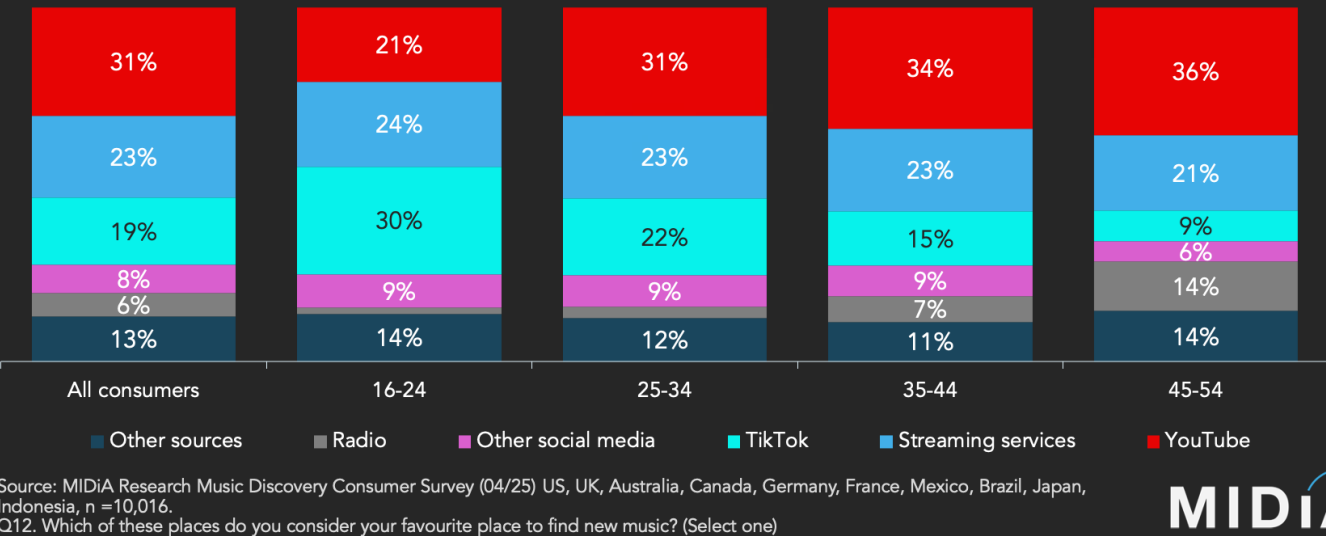
Music on social media is as much a reflection of what is happening in the wider music consumption ecosystem as it is a driver of it.

YouTube and streaming are consumers' favourite discovery methods

Music discovery is fragmented. When we asked consumers what their favourite music discovery source is, the most a single source garnered was 31% (YouTube). Meanwhile, TikTok and other social media combined were just 27%. This means that prioritising any single platform essentially cuts out the majority of music fans, even if that is done for targeting purposes. For example, only 30% of 16-24-year-olds say TikTok is their favourite place for discovery.

Only a minority of consumers say social media is their favourite place to discover music

Favourite places to find new music



Combining streaming and YouTube is the only way to reach more than half of music fans via their preferred discovery choice with just two sources. In fact, the YouTube / streaming combination reaches more than half of all consumers across all age groups except 16-24s, where it reaches 45%.

TikTok has a significant 16-24 gender divide

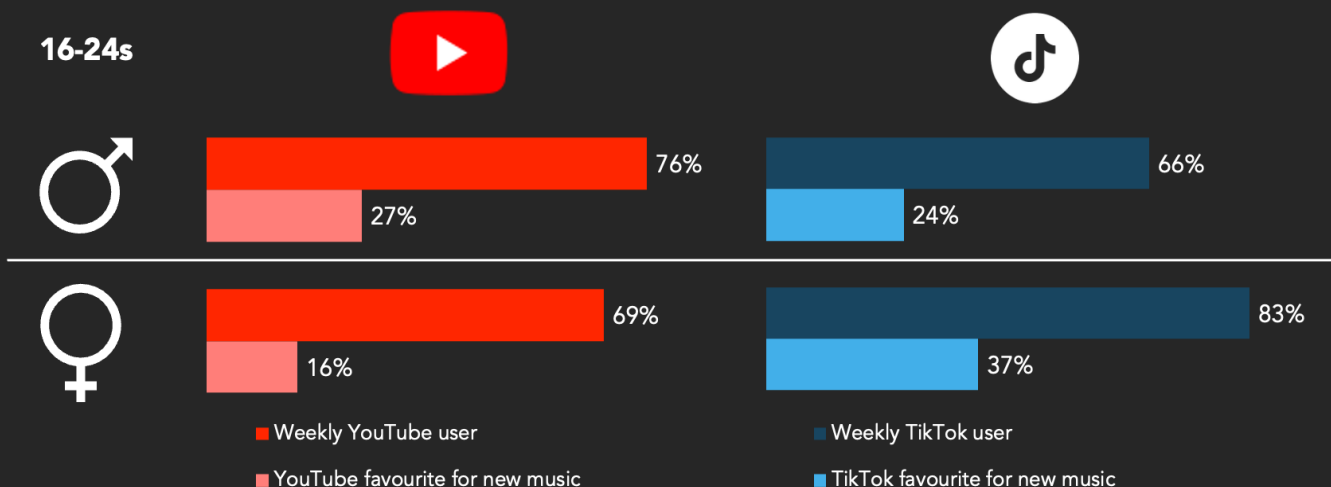
There are clear gender divides between TikTok and YouTube when looking at the 16-24 age bracket. For example, 83% of 16-24-year-old females use TikTok weekly, 14 percentage points more than those who use YouTube weekly. Thus, 37% of 16-24-year-old females say TikTok is their favourite place for music discovery, 21 percentage points higher than those who choose YouTube as their top discovery platform.

There is a slightly more balanced view for young males.

They are still more likely to use YouTube and say it is top for discovery compared to TikTok, but by a smaller margin of 10 and 3 percentage points, respectively. TikTok, therefore, emerges as an effective place to reach younger females, but YouTube presents the best opportunity for reaching younger audiences across both genders.

The TikTok gender divide: 16-24 males strongly under-index for using TikTok, whereas YouTube is more balanced

Music behaviours of 16-24s by gender across YouTube and TikTok



Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25) US, UK, Australia, Canada, Germany, France, Mexico, Brazil, Japan, Indonesia, n =10,016. Q1A. What social platforms do you use weekly? (Select all that apply) and Q12. Which of these places do you consider your favourite place to find new music? (Select one)

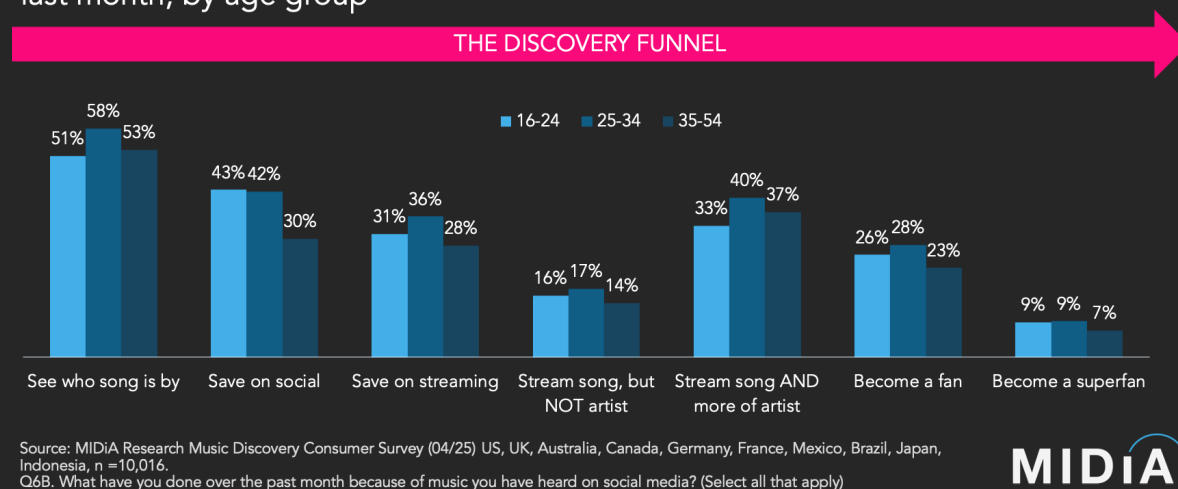
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STATE OF FUNNEL

16-24-year-olds are getting stuck in the funnel, if they enter at all

Discovery drop-off | The funnel from social to streaming and artist discovery is weaker for 16-24s than 25-34s

Among consumers who hear music on social media, actions after hearing it in the last month, by age group



Simply being exposed to music on social media matters little if consumers do not stream the music they hear, or better yet, discover the artists behind it. After hearing music on social media, consumers aged 16-24 are less likely than 25-34-year-olds to take almost every step through the funnel, from looking to see who the song is by to saving it on streaming via the “add to music app” to exploring more of the artist’s music and becoming a fan.

Consumers aged 16-24 are less likely than 25-34-year-olds to take almost every step through the funnel.

The link from song to artist discovery is showing weakness

Both age groups are more likely to stream the song they heard and more music from the artist than to stream just the song alone. However, 16-24-year-olds are still less likely than 25-34-year-olds to do either of these things.

Song-to-artist discovery is the weak link. Of 16-24s who discovered new artists they loved in the past year, only 19% went on to listen to more music from that artist, a difference of -5% compared to 25-34s. Younger consumers are less likely to discover new artists in the first place – and even when they do discover, they are less likely to listen.

Younger consumers are less likely to discover new artists in the first place – and even when they do discover, they are less likely to listen.

Even disregarding demographic trends, the fact that almost half of consumers (48%) did not stream music they heard on social media in the last month, and fewer than a third became fans, illustrates that most of the activity aimed at driving discovery does not translate. As the old John Wanamaker quote goes: “*Half the money I spend on advertising is wasted; the trouble is I don’t know which half.*”

Almost half of consumers (48%) did not stream music they heard on social media in the last month, and fewer than a third became fans.

The more reliant users are on algorithms, the less music they hear

Algorithms shape our behaviours, but most so on social apps. Consumers who hear music on TikTok and Instagram are significantly more likely to say they do not search for music compared to consumers who hear music on YouTube.

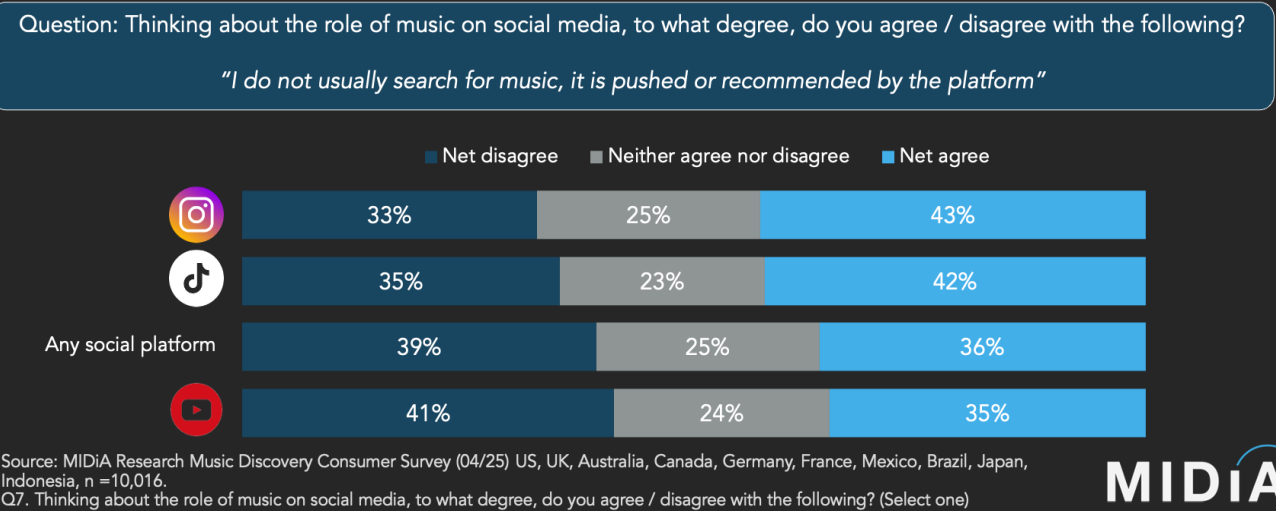
Consumers who do not actively search for music are more likely to *prefer* non-music sounds in their feeds (43%), and to say music is becoming *less* a part of their feeds (39%).

Hyper-personalisation risks reducing the agency of choice that is so important for cultivating fandom. Here, the music industry faces a chicken-or-egg dilemma.

Are the people who say they are pushed music already less likely to actively seek it, or has the pushing made them less active in their discovery? Whatever the answer, an over-reliance on social algorithms is at the very least part of a dumbing down of music discovery, consumption, and fandom.

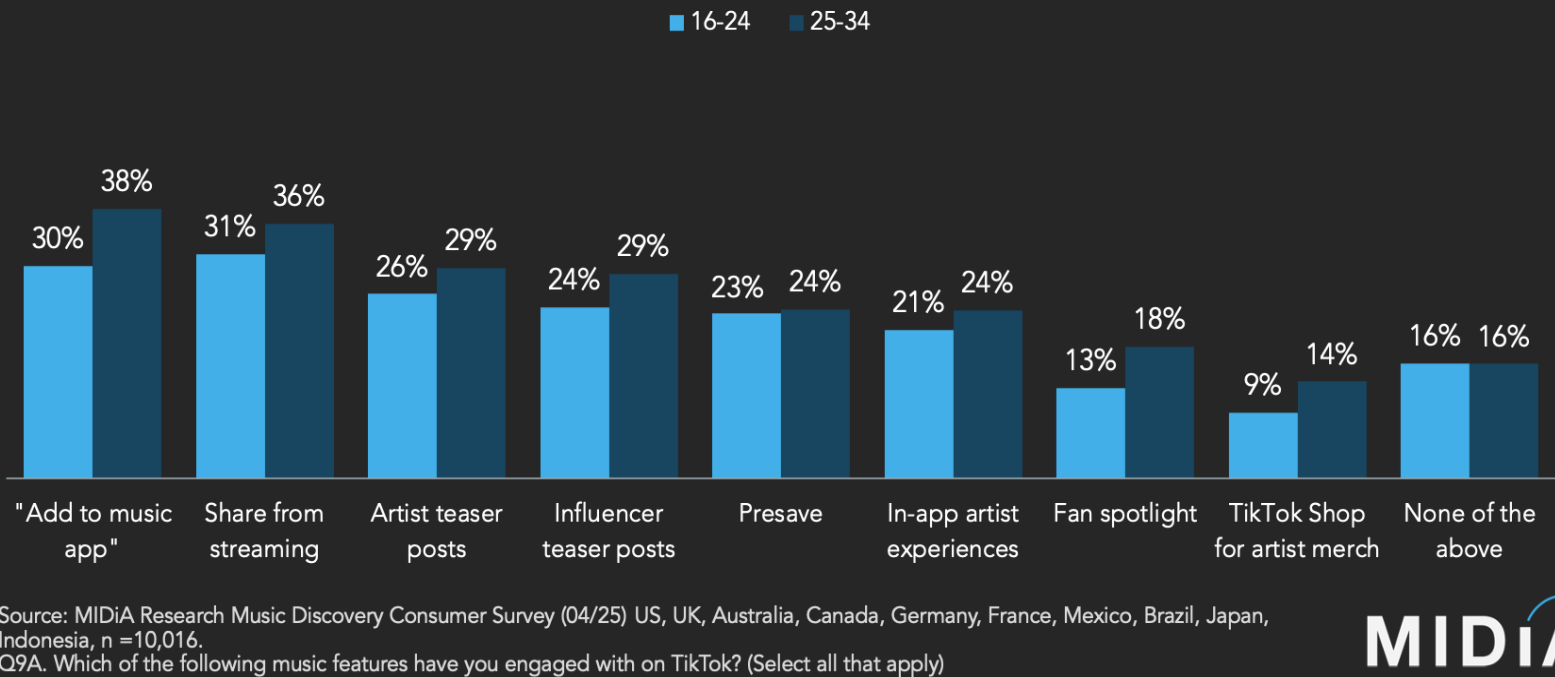
Consumers who hear music on Instagram and TikTok are less likely to search for it, and more reliant on algorithms

Consumers who hear music on social platforms, by platform, and attitudes towards statement



16-24s may use TikTok more, but they use TikTok’s music features less

Percentage of TikTok users who have used in-app music features, by age group



TikTok has built numerous features to help drive music engagement, and they have enjoyed success, with only 21% of TikTok users never having used any of the surveyed options. No single feature, however, is being used at scale. Only 33% of consumers have ever used its most popular feature – “add to music app”.

16-24-year-olds are less likely than 25-34-year-olds to have used any one of TikTok’s music feature. The difference is most stark for “add to music app”, which 30% of 16-24s have ever used, compared to 38% of 25-34s. This matters because it is central to the link between hearing a track and listening to it on streaming platforms.

TikTok drives artist “follows” more than it does streams

After discovering a new artist, consumers who mainly discover music on TikTok are significantly more likely to follow that artist on TikTok (35%) than they are to listen to more of that artist’s music (23%). In other words, when TikTok users discover artists, they are more interested in following their content than in listening to their music on streaming platforms.TikTok is driving more TikTok consumption rather than streaming consumption.

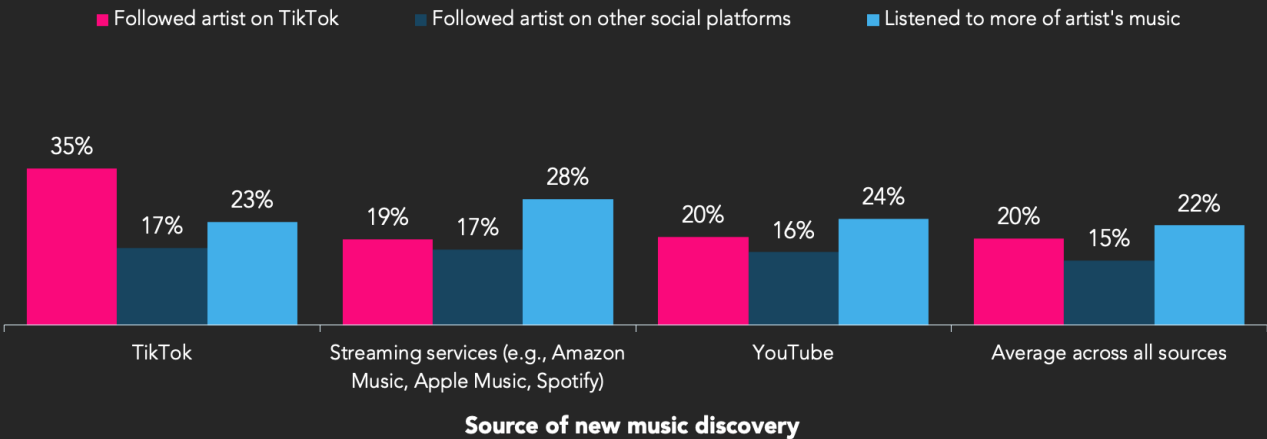
TikTok is the only major discovery method where this is the case. Consumers who discover on YouTube and streaming services are more likely to listen to more of an artist’s music than follow them on social.

However, there is a broader issue for artist discovery: TikTok, YouTube, and streaming services all result in less than one-third of users listening to more music by an artist after discovering them.

When TikTok users discover artists, they are more interested in following their content than in listening to their music on streaming platforms.TikTok is driving more TikTok consumption rather than streaming consumption.

Consumers who discover artists on TikTok are more likely to follow them than to stream more of their music

Consumer actions following the most recent time discovering an artist, by platform where they discover new music



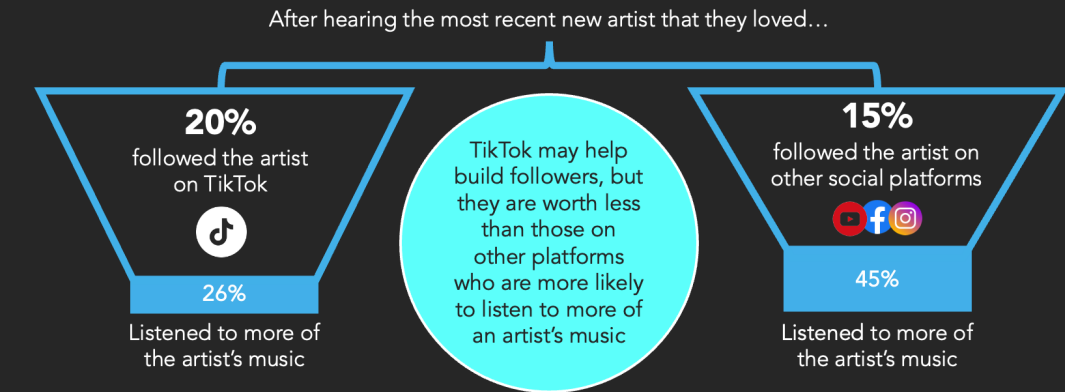
Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25) US, UK, Australia, Canada, Germany, France, Mexico, Brazil, Japan, Indonesia, n =10,016. Q15. Think about the most recent artist that you have heard for the first time and loved. What did you do after you heard this artist? (Select all that apply)



TikTok follows provide a hollow funnel for shallow consumption

Followers ≠ listens | Close to three-quarters of users who follow artists on TikTok do not explore that artist’s music

Consumer actions after recently discovering an artist



Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25) US, UK, Australia, Canada, Germany, France, Mexico, Brazil, Japan, Indonesia, n =10,016. Q15. Think about the most recent artist that you have heard for the first time and loved. What did you do after you heard this artist? (Select all that apply)



The theory is that more social followers mean more streams, and those streams lift up the rest of the artist’s catalogue. The reality is often very different, particularly so on TikTok.

TikTok users are often satisfied with the artist content they receive on the platform, and do not feel the need to migrate to streaming services.

Of the 20% of consumers who followed artists on TikTok after discovering them, only 26% listened to more of that artist’s music. Yet, of the 15% of consumers who followed artists on other social platforms after discovering them, 45% listened to more of that artist’s music.

The more artists post on TikTok, the less their followers feel the need to listen to their music off-platform.

The social conversion funnel is leaky: the majority of social media followers are not exploring artist catalogues.

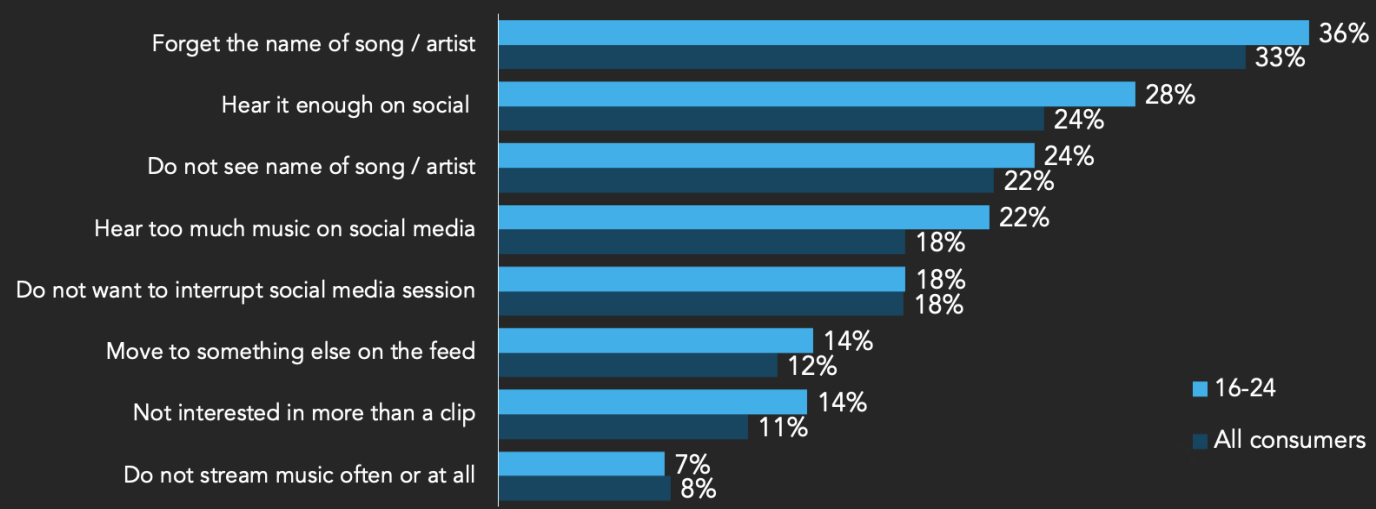
TikTok users are often satisfied with the artist content they receive on the platform, and do not feel the need to migrate to streaming services. The pressure for artists to accrue TikTok followers may actually be detrimental to their streaming income – the more artists post on TikTok, the less their followers feel the need to listen to their music off-platform.

SOCIAL CAPTURES VALUE MORE THAN DRIVING IT

Social media is beginning to eat streaming’s role in music consumption

Social is both a consumption end-point and a contextless place of discovery

What audiences perceive as the biggest barrier to streaming the music they first hear on social



Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25) US, UK, Australia, Canada, Germany, France, Mexico, Brazil, Japan, Indonesia, n =10,016. Q8. What do you think are the biggest barriers to streaming the music you hear on social media (i.e., on Spotify, Apple Music, YouTube Music, etc.)? (Select all that apply)



Just over one-third (36%) of consumers say that music matters a lot to their social media experience and that they always pay attention to it. However, getting them to follow it anywhere else is difficult.

28% of 16-24-year-olds say their biggest barrier to streaming the music they hear on social media is that they already hear it enough there, while over a fifth say they hear too much music on social media. The inconvenient truth is that the more that music is pushed at social users, the less impactful it becomes.

The funnel is not just clogging – it is turning in on itself

Added into this mix, 18% of consumers do not want to leave their social feed when they hear new music, and by the time that they do, 33% have forgotten what the music was or did not even see the song’s name in the first place. Snippets of music fly past in the torrent of social feeds. TikTok is a great place to reach many people – but it is likely you will only reach them once.

The ‘funnel’ from social to streaming is not only breaking, but actively driving activity back to the social platforms, often in competition with streaming.

Music marketers want to drive social users off-platform, and the platforms want them to stay. When YouTube had this issue in its early days, the resolution was for the platform to shift to become a music listening destination in its own right. We are now at a similar point for TikTok, where the platform and the wider industry may need to consider it a destination rather than an ad host – with a royalty model and revenue streams to match.

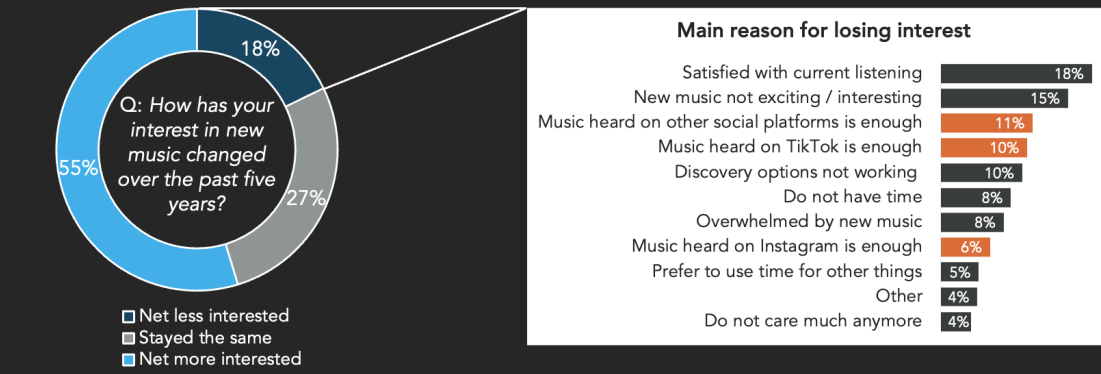
The ‘funnel’ from social to streaming is not only breaking, but actively driving activity back to the social platforms, often in competition with streaming. In short, younger audiences in particular see music as an intrinsic and satisfying part of their social experience; following it elsewhere can seem unnecessary.

CHANGING THE MODEL

There is a silver lining – but the clock is ticking to capture it

Most 16-24s say their interest in music discovery has grown. For those who lost interest, social media contributes

Interest in new music over past five years, and main reasons for becoming less interested, 16-24s, global



Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25) US, UK, Australia, Canada, Germany, France, Mexico, Brazil, Japan, Indonesia, n =10,016. Q17. How has your interest in new music changed over the past five years? (Select one) and Q19. What is the main reason why you have become less interested in discovering new music? (Select one)



Despite the indication that younger generations are disengaged with music and artists, there is a silver lining: nobody wants it to be this way. Not the music industry, and apparently not younger consumers, either. More than half of 16-24-year-olds (55%) say they have become more interested in finding new music, and half say they expect their interest to grow.

Social media risks standing in the way of serving these consumers’ needs. 16-24s are the least likely to think the music being released is not exciting or interesting (15%), but are the most likely to have lost interest because the music they hear on TikTok, Instagram and other social platforms is enough for them (28% combined). It is not the quality of new music that is holding younger consumers back from deeper discovery – it is the pull of the social media void.

It is not the quality of new music that is holding younger consumers back from deeper discovery – it is the pull of the social media void.

Living with a social status quo

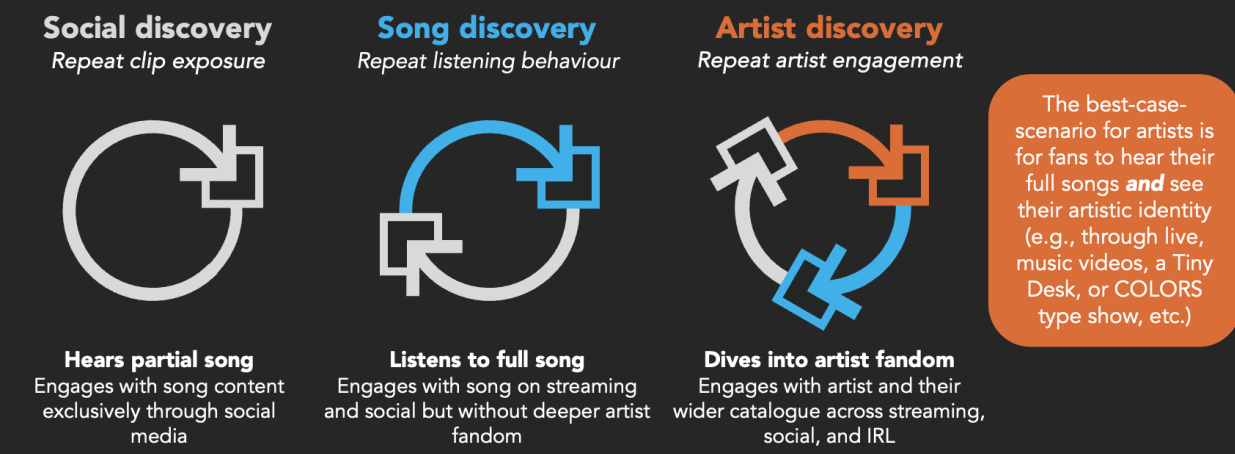
Social media is not going anywhere; if anything, its role in culture is going to grow. We are entering a zero-sum game with little room for any player in entertainment to carve out new spaces for attention. Social media’s growth is increasingly at the expense of other sources of entertainment, rather than as a complement to them. In this landscape, there is no incentive for social platforms to send their users to another platform (unless it is under the same parent, e.g., YouTube and YouTube Music).

This means artists cannot depend on social platforms to drive discovery. What social platforms ultimately do is capture value. The question is, do artists and their teams capture enough value for themselves?

We are entering a zero-sum game with little room for any player in entertainment to carve out new spaces for attention. Social media’s growth is increasingly at the expense of other sources of entertainment, rather than as a complement to them.

The discovery funnel is a cycle forged by first impressions

Framework for the music discovery cycle



Source: MIDiA Research



Amid the generational divides of YouTube and TikTok, streaming platforms have remained a more consistent force for both song and artist discovery. Close to half (46%) of those who say streaming is their favourite place to discover music stream more music from an artist after discovering them, compared to 34% who say TikTok is their favourite.

When discovery begins on streaming, where users can engage with full songs and artist catalogues, the transition to social content becomes an extension of fandom rather than a substitute for consumption. It is worth noting that 68% of consumers who say streaming platforms are their top discovery source use Spotify.

While marketing campaigns often expect discovery to flow from social to streaming, the reverse may actually be more effective. This repositions streaming services at the top of the discovery funnel. In reality, however, the “funnel” is an inappropriate analogy – really, we are looking at a discovery cycle.

The key is what the cycle starts with. If the cycle begins with attention to the full song and artist, subsequent exposure through social media clips sends audiences back to listen again, deepening engagement with each pass. However, if the cycle begins with a clip or a snippet of a song, then the itch is for returning to the moment – the snippet – not the song or the artist.

This is partly by design. On social media, the platform's incentive is for the bare minimum amount of music that will keep people attached to their feed. In this world, music is indistinguishable from non-music sounds. It is all simply audio that either leads to engagement and retention, in which case it is brought to the surface, or it does not, in which case it is buried.

TikTok's 'fork in the road' moment

Labels and artists cannot fix discovery on their own. The platforms must do their part – and this is where TikTok faces a key choice.

Music is important to the user experience on TikTok and across social media platforms. Of those who hear music on TikTok, for example, 94% say that music matters to social media – and within that, 28% say it is “essential”. However, TikTok is not a music platform and is moving away from being a music-centric one, with a vast and ever-growing variety of content types now competing for user attention.

In this world, music is indistinguishable from non-music sounds. It is all simply audio that either leads to engagement and retention, in which case it is brought to the surface, or it does not, in which case it is buried.

Those users are divided. Nearly the same percentage of those who hear music on TikTok agree that they prefer *non*-music sounds in their feed (32%) as those who disagree (37%), with the rest landing in the middle. This leaves TikTok at a fork in the road: Does it focus on repairing the funnel towards music discovery, or does it push deeper into non-music content?

This leaves clear action points for all players involved:

ARTISTS: Make your first impression count

LABELS AND RIGHTSHOLDERS: Put artists on a platform, not in a platform

PLATFORMS: Make a choice

ARTISTS

Make your first impression count

Posting relentlessly to social media *reduces* the need for fans to listen and engage off-platform. Instead of aiming to reach as many people as possible, focus on reaching the biggest fans on the platforms which are more aligned with your scene but more effective at driving listenership and fandom.

It has never been more important for artists to have clarity on their identity and narrative in order to determine what the best channels are to express that identity. This may well be TikTok for music like K-Pop that soundtracks dance content, but for hip hop and metal artists engaged with gaming scenes, Discord and Twitch are no-brainers.

Focus broader marketing efforts on spaces where listening to music is a natural, built-in next step to discovery – streaming and YouTube – rather than feed-based platforms where migration causes friction.

It has never been more important for artists to have clarity on their identity and narrative in order to determine what the best channels are to express that identity.

LABELS AND RIGHTSHOLDERS

Put artists *on* a platform, not *in* a platform

Take heed of the limits (and negatives) of social media marketing for songs and artists. Invest in revitalising discovery sources beyond TikTok, YouTube, and Spotify, which currently serve as bottlenecks for discovery. Recognise that if fans get hooked on a hook, then a hook is all they will need. If their first point of contact is with the artist and the narratives behind the music they make, then that is what fans will keep coming back to.

There will always be opportunities to soundtrack a viral craze with trending music. There is only one opportunity to make a first impression and to build a career on fandom; that impression needs to put the artist front and centre. Start the discovery cycle strong and reap the rewards.

There is only one opportunity to make a first impression and to build a career on fandom; that impression needs to put the artist front and centre.

PLATFORMS

Make a choice

The platforms must decide what their role in music discovery and consumption is going to be. Streaming services and social media platforms pushing non-music content will have an impact on their users and the broader industry. It may meet consumer demand for some, but what platforms cannot ignore is the way music forms the soundtrack of wider lifestyles and cultures that drive the leading categories of entertainment. Pushing music away only serves to diminish the cultures that platforms depend on for capturing attention in the first place.

The path forward for the future music business

Ultimately, music rightsholders have a decision to make about how they view social platforms. Are they primarily marketing tools, consumption platforms, or equally both?

For labels, the answer will determine:

- The volume of marketing effort invested in social media
- The marketing objectives
- The licensing models

The same question was asked of YouTube half a decade ago, and the answer proved to be option three. Now, YouTube is both a major driver of rightsholder revenue and the primary music discovery method. It is now decision time for social media.

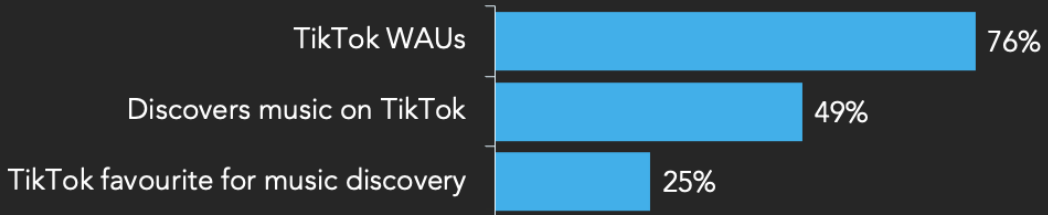
COUNTRY CASE STUDIES

MEXICO

A TikTok-heavy market where more than half do not stream the songs they discover

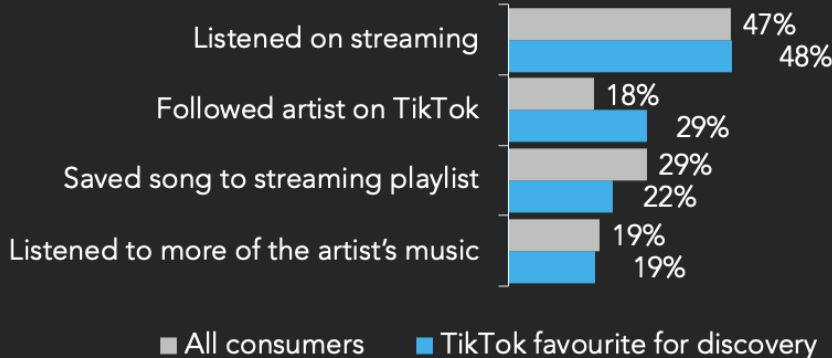


TikTok WAUs and discovery behaviours



- Mexico is a TikTok-heavy market, with nearly half of consumers discovering music on the platform and **25%** saying TikTok is their favourite place to discover music

Post song discovery actions for users who say TikTok is their favourite music discovery source



- After discovering a song, **29%** of those who say TikTok is their favourite discovery source follow an artist on the platform, but only **19%** listen to more of that artist's music
- Those who say TikTok is their favourite place to discover music are less likely than general consumers to save the songs they discover onto a streaming playlist

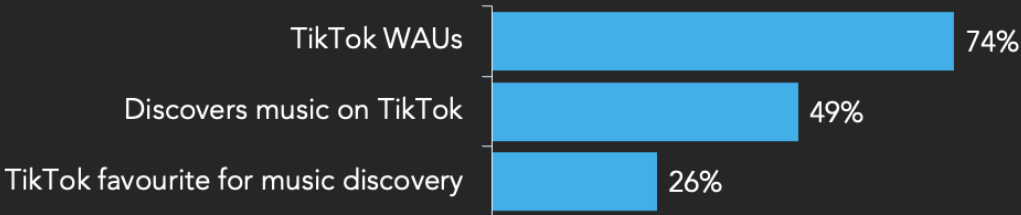
Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25), Mexico, n = 1,004

INDONESIA

Those who prefer to discover songs on TikTok are less likely to stream and listen to more of the artist's music

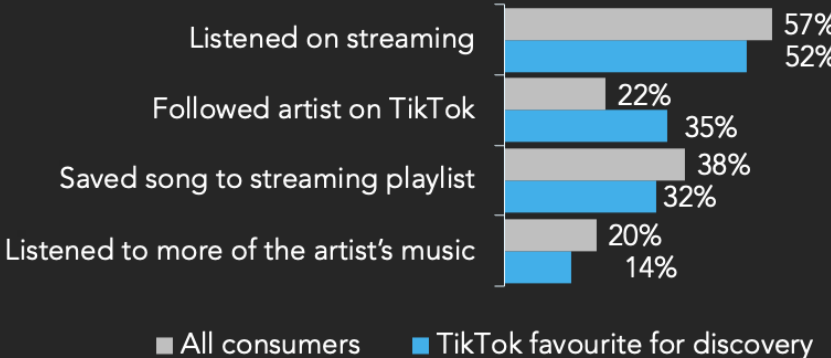


TikTok WAUs and discovery behaviours



- Indonesia is another TikTok-heavy market, with the second-highest WAUs after Mexico at **74%**

Post song discovery actions for users who say TikTok is their favourite music discovery source



- TikTok discovery drives streaming less than the consumer average – **52%** of users who discover music mainly on TikTok listen to songs on streaming platforms after discovery, compared to the 57% average
- Discovery on TikTok rarely leads to artist discovery – respondents who named TikTok as their main discovery method under-index for listening to more of the artist's music (**14%** compared to a 20% average)

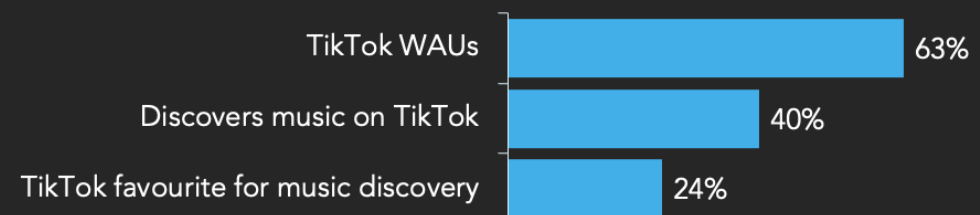
Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25), Indonesia, n = 1,002



FRANCE

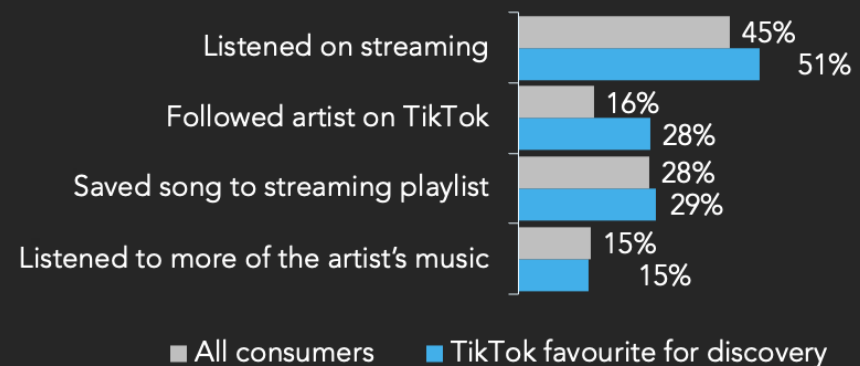
TikTok is the favourite music discovery source, but does little to build fandom

TikTok WAUs and discovery behaviours



- While France does not have the highest percentage of TikTok WAUs, TikTok comes out on top as a favourite discovery source above YouTube (23%) and Radio (15%)

Post song discovery actions for users who say TikTok is their favourite music discovery source

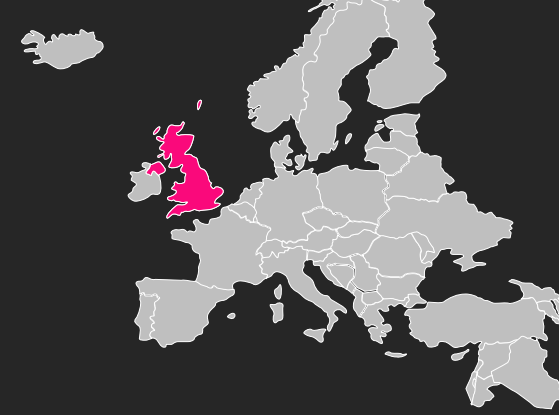


- Those who say TikTok is their top discovery source are more likely to listen to the song they discover on streaming. However, **29%** say they spend less time streaming music because of TikTok
- France also has the poorest artist fandom conversion, with only **12%** of users who say TikTok is their favourite discovery source becoming a fan of an artist they heard and **6%** becoming a superfan

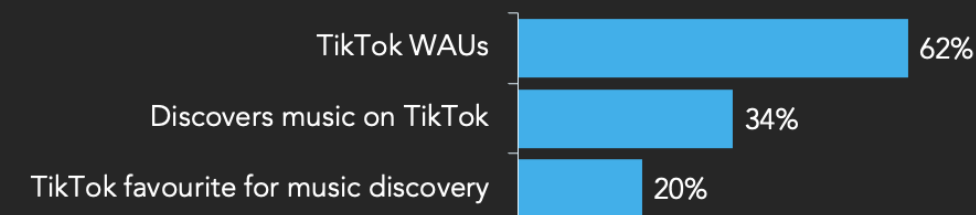
Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25), France, n = 1,004

UK

A stronger social to streaming funnel does not lead to more artist consumption

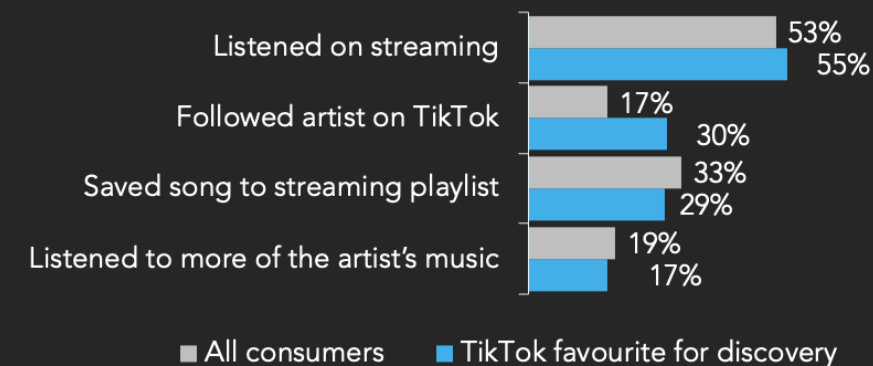


TikTok WAUs and discovery behaviours



- The UK is similar to France regarding TikTok WAUs and how many users hear music on the app, but has stronger streaming conversion – **36%** of TikTok users spend more time streaming music because of TikTok

Post song discovery actions for users who say TikTok is their favourite music discovery source



- However, there are still barriers to streaming – **44%** of those who say TikTok is their favourite place for music discovery forget name of artist they hear on social, compared to 36% of all UK consumers
- Much of fan behaviour stays on TikTok – **30%** of users who discover mainly on TikTok follow the artist on TikTok after discovering them, and only **17%** listen to more of the artist's music on streaming

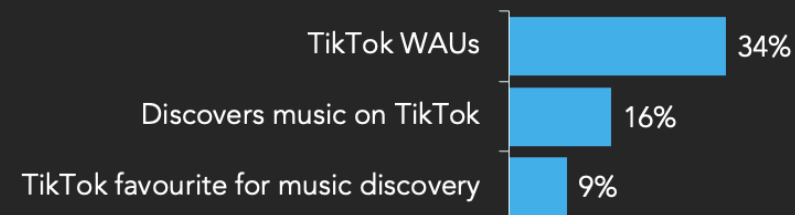
Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25), UK, n = 1,000



JAPAN

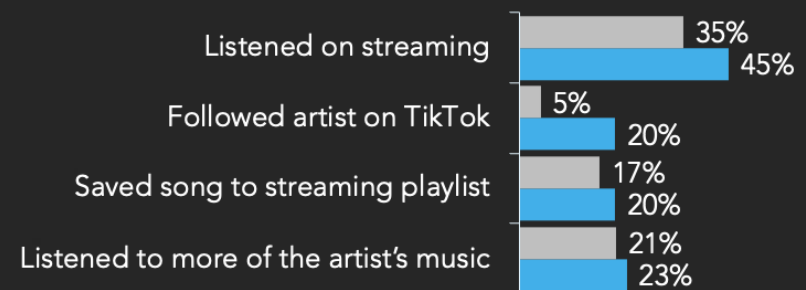
TikTok is a niche discovery source, and its adoption is coming at the expense of YouTube

TikTok WAUs and discovery behaviours



- Japan has the lowest proportion of users who use TikTok weekly (**34%**), and the lowest for discovery (**16%**)

Post song discovery actions for users who say TikTok is their favourite music discovery source



■ All consumers ■ TikTok favourite for discovery

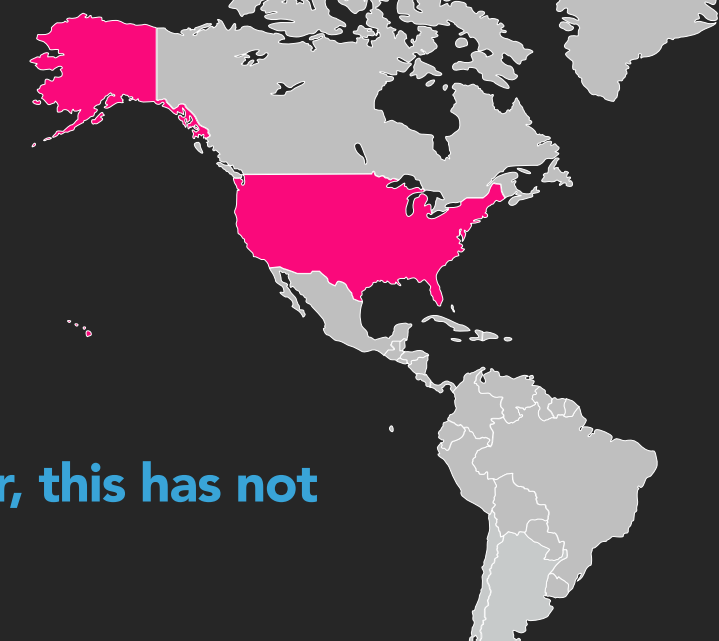
Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25), Japan, n = 1,003

- Those who say TikTok is their favourite discovery source are more likely to listen to the songs they discover on streaming, and **37%** say they spend more time streaming because of TikTok

- However, Japan is a YouTube-heavy market and TikTok consumption is coming at the expense of YouTube – **35%** who say TikTok is their favourite discovery source listen to songs they discover on YouTube, compared to 52% average for Japan

US

More people are saving songs in the US – however, this has not helped with artist discovery

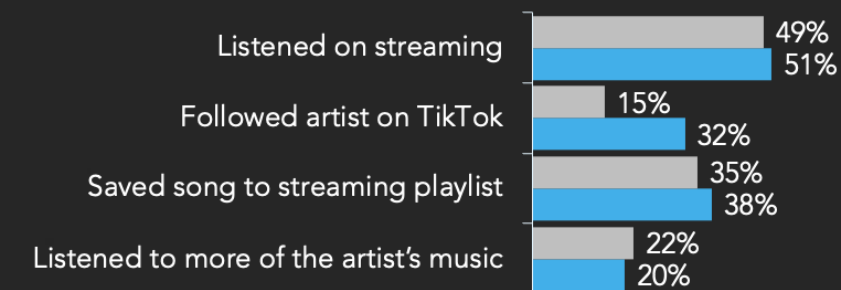


TikTok WAUs and discovery behaviours



- The US has one of the lowest rates of those who say TikTok is their favourite place to discover music (**16%**)

Post song discovery actions for users who say TikTok is their favourite music discovery source



■ All consumers ■ TikTok favourite for discovery

Source: MIDiA Research Music Discovery Consumer Survey (04/25), US, n = 1,000

- 38%** of those who say TikTok is their top discovery source are saving the song to a playlist, which is one the highest rates across all markets

- Song discovery and consumption has not translated into significant uplift in artist discovery for those who prefer to discover on TikTok, with only **20%** listening to more of an artist's music, compared to the US average of 22%